Exploration rule – Food and water · SRD 5.2.1

A character needs **1 pound of food** and **1 gallon of water** per day (**2 gallons** in hot weather). They can eat **half rations** to last longer. Without enough food or water, they risk **exhaustion**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **1 lb** of food per day.
2. **1 gallon** of water per day (2 in hot weather).
3. Without food: **3 + Con** days, then exhaustion.
4. Half water: **Con DC 15** or exhaustion.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps the 2014 needs; exhaustion follows the new SRD 2024 rules.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say how to resupply on the road. Fix: a Survival check lets you look for food and water.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe lukewarm water, the last loaf of bread and gnawing hunger.

Step 1 – Count:

Note the group's rations and waterskins.

Step 2 – Consume:

Each day: 1 lb of food, 1 gallon of water (2 in hot weather).

Step 3 – Ration:

Half rations: the group lasts longer but tires.

Step 4 – Rolls:

Without food: 3 + Con days, then 1 exhaustion level per day. Half water: Con DC 15 per day.

Step 5 – Recover:

Exhaustion from hunger or thirst clears only after a full meal and drink.

Example: Faelan (Con +2) lasts 5 days without food, then loses 1 exhaustion level per extra day.

Level	Cumulative effect
1	–2 to d20 tests, Speed –5 ft
2	–4 to d20 tests, Speed –10 ft
3	–6 to d20 tests, Speed –15 ft
4	–8 to d20 tests, Speed –20 ft
5	–10 to d20 tests, Speed –25 ft
6	Death

⚠ Common questions:

How much food per day?

1 lb.

How much water per day?

1 gallon (2 in hot weather).

What do half rations do?

They stretch supplies.

How many days without food?

3 + Con modifier (minimum 1).

And with half water?

Con DC 15, else 1 exhaustion level.

How do I recover?

By eating and drinking fully.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Hunting

Does hunting compensate? **Option**: Survival DC 10 to 15 for 1d6 + Wis lb.

Dirty water

Drinking foul water. **Option**: Con DC 10 or Poisoned.

Magic rations

Create Food and Water replaces rations. **Option**: yes.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Exhaustion

Each level: –2 to d20 tests and –5 ft Speed.

Need

1 lb of food and 1 gallon of water per day.

Recovery

You must eat and drink normally.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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